

Rahaf Abutarbush

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EDUCATION

Carnegie Mellon University, BSC. in Information Systems

Sep 2018 – May 2022

- Minor: Business Administration, concentration in Human-computer Interaction & User Experience
- Honors: Senior Leadership Award, Dean's list 2021

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

PwC Middle East, Emerging Tech Innovation lead & Qatar Lead

May 2022 – present

- Led Qatar's Emerging Technology lab, shaping strategy, overseeing operations and mentoring team members
- Directed ideation sessions and roundtables for government and SME clients including CEOs, governors, and ministers, leading to **20+** projects and proposals
- Generated over **\$18M** in leveraged revenue by identifying emerging tech opportunities with client delivery teams
- Established research pillar, continuously tracking global and regional trends to guide strategy, facilitate prototype production, and stay ahead of the curve
- Authored **30+** reports on emerging technologies, evaluating business value and conducting risk assessments
- Fostered strong relationships with senior stakeholders and clients, transforming their visions and challenges into actionable research plans and proof of concepts
- Delivered **90+** engaging workshops and presentations on AI, XR, and emerging technologies, reaching **1000+** clients and internal teams while ensuring accessibility across various technical literacy levels
- **Promoted** to regional head of emerging tech innovation, serving as a cross-functional bridge between developers, internal stakeholders, and external clients to deliver high-impact, experience focused prototypes
- Designed an iterative prototyping process, prioritizing concept validation, story crafting, and client presentation

RK Design, Founder

Dec 2021 – present

- Collaborated with clients to transform business goals into innovative digital experiences
- Audited existing websites for usability and design, providing strategic recommendations to enhance average session duration, conversion rates, and lower bounce rates
- Led end-to-end project management, from concept and wireframing to execution to ensure seamless delivery

KEY PROJECTS

- Virtual AI Humans & Clickable Videos - Built and showcased innovation in distance learning for government client
- GenAI Use Case Inventory - Compiled a list of 500+ use cases for various industries and lines of service
- Tourism Authority R&D Playbook - Created framework and KPIs to measure success of the new department
- Conversational AI - Built agent utilizing Realtime API and engineered prompts to ensure an intuitive tone
- Thought leadership - Wrote on Emerging Technologies in the Middle East in 2025
- Keynotes - Women in Tech PwC x Microsoft, Smart Cities Doha (*Shaping the Smart Cities of the Future*), LEAP 2024 (*Future of XR*), Euronews (*Into the Metaverse*), Ru'ya (*Transforming the Workforce with Emerging Tech*)

SKILLS & ENGAGEMENTS

Languages

Arabic (Native) English (Fluent)

Ecosystem Engagement

- Business Innovation Mentor at Lifelines Hackathon 2024
- Judge at Tech Startup Launchpad 2023 & 2024

Extracurriculars & Leadership Roles

- Captain of Carnegie Mellon Arabic Debate Team
- President & Executive Producer of TEDxCMUQ
- Media Manager of TEDxyouthAlDafna
- Course Assistant for Junior Consulting Project
- Outreach director of Information Systems Association

Production Skills

Figma, Video & Photo Editing, Podcast Production, Script Writing

Technical Skills

Python, Java, Ruby on Rails, Tableau, SQL, PHP, R, Web Development, Prompt Engineering

Representation at Global & Regional Events

- Microsoft Data Center Launch (Qatar)
- LEAP 2023 & 2024 (KSA)
- Metaverse & AI Assembly 2022/2023 (U.A.E)
- World AI Summit 2024 (Qatar)
- DEALS 2023 (Spain)